

PHOTOS BY MILIND SHELTE



Emeritus, IGIDR; **Dinesh Khara**, Former Chairman, & CEO, NSE India; **Zarin Daruwala**, Group Chief

AFTER A RIGOROUS process of engaging with banks, NBFCs, fintechs, and analysing large volumes of data to shortlist the top three nominees in as many as eleven categories, it was time to choose the best of the best for the 30th edition of the BT-KPMG Best Banks & NBFCs Survey. The jury met at Mumbai's NSE boardroom on a toasty January morning to decide the winners.

In a first in nine years, BT constituted a larger seven-member jury—led by Dinesh

Khara, former Chairman, State Bank of India—to decide 13 jury awards. The other jury members were Ashima Goyal, Professor Emeritus, IGIDR; Zarin Daruwala, Group Chief Executive at PL Capital, and former CEO, Standard Chartered Bank; G. N. Bajpai, Founder & Chairman, GovEva and former Chairman of SEBI and LIC; Gunit Chadha, Founder, APAC Financial Services and former CEO, Deutsche Bank; Ashish Chauhan, MD & CEO, NSE India; and Surojit Shome, former MD & CEO, DBS Bank India.

Customer experience, impact of innovation, succession planning, and scalability of initiatives were the points of focus during the discussion. The jury also discussed the challenges faced by public-sector banks, especially in talent management, given the relatively low compensation and absence of hire-and-fire flexibility as available to private and foreign banks.

At the end of the deliberations, the jury finalised 12 awards out of 13 categories. The category Best in Innovation (Private Banks) was dropped due to the absence of strong entries.

ICICI Bank, L&T Finance, and HSBC India emerged as standout performers, winning two awards each. The selection of ICICI Bank as Bank of the Year was unanimous despite the bank having won the honour for five consecutive years. There was also unanimity in conferring the Lifetime Achievement

Award on Shaktikanta Das, former Governor of the Reserve Bank of India.

Together with the seven quantitative (non-jury) awards, the study features a total of 19 awards this year. HDFC Bank was excluded from the quantitative study due to the merger of HDFC Ltd into the bank during the past three-year period.

Our knowledge partner KPMG ran the process of selecting the best three nominees in each category and conducted the quantitative ranking.

QUANTITATIVE AWARDS

For rankings based on pure financial performance, data was taken from published annual reports of banks for FY22 to FY25, except for the data on the number of branches of a few foreign banks, which was sourced from their official websites.

The survey covered 53 scheduled commercial banks that had published annual reports in the public domain or had provided their annual reports prior to October 31, 2025.

Foreign banks with a balance sheet size of less than ₹25,000 crore as on March 31, 2025 were not considered for the survey. Also not covered were scheduled commercial banks whose financial statements were not available, or which had not completed three years of operations in India as on March 31, 2025, or were involved in mergers in the last three years, or were under liquidation.